Build your first small store

Real build companion | Clear Desk Essentials | 16 October 2026

The outcome

Create a coherent catalogue, edit the storefront, inspect every page and verify the basket. Follow the actual controls in your account; features and allowances can change.

Our training example

Clear Desk Essentials is a fictional desk-accessory shop, separate from the Clear Desk Support service website. Prices, stock, dimensions and product descriptions are sample data. Original schematic artwork is used, not merchandise photography.

What was verified

Saved identity, category and three products; hero, FAQ and footer edits; published page previews; sorting and category; every product page; two notebooks at GHS240, one at GHS120, then an empty cart.

What was not verified

No order or payment was submitted. Confirmation messages, paid checkout, order stock deduction and delivery remain untested. The builder mobile preview is not a real-device acceptance test.

Final demonstration state

Sample products were returned to Draft and all payment methods switched off. The design remains saved/published; the store was not archived or deleted. Do not treat this example as an operational shop.

Plan a catalogue people understand

Complete these facts before opening Add product

Audience and store purpose

Who will browse? Which related items belong in this first catalogue?

Identity and address

Store name, readable slug, tagline, description and announcement.

Product truth

What exactly is included? What shown in the image is excluded?

Price and unit

Currency, amount, unit, taxes and delivery information to confirm.

Images and rights

Accurate photographs or clearly labelled illustrations you own or may use.

Create the identity and category

Online Store -> Store settings -> Business details

1 / Resume the correct store

We resumed an existing empty Untitled draft. Check the active workspace and store before editing. Do not overwrite a customer store for practice.

2 / Save the identity

Enter name, slug, tagline, description and announcement. Upload the logo and wait for the upload. Save and confirm the saved state.

3 / Create a category

Products -> categories -> Desk essentials. A category groups products; it does not create another item.

4 / Keep real launch facts separate

Use truthful contact, policies and delivery details for a real business. A saved identity does not establish a working checkout.

Your store name / slug / category

Write the exact values and saved confirmation:

Enter all three products

Products -> Add product | Sample currency is GHS

Notebook / CDE-NOTE-01

A5 Desk Notebook - Demo. GHS120 per notebook. Example stock10. Teal cover and lined pages; dimensions are fictional training data.

Holder / CDE-HOLD-01

Desk Pen Holder - Demo. GHS90 per holder. Example stock10. Pens in the illustration are excluded.

Clips / CDE-CLIP-01

Cable Clips, Set of 3 - Demo. GHS60 per set of three. Example stock10. State the pack size in the unit field.

For each product

Name; factual description; price and unit; SKU; category; stock; main image; status. Leave comparison price empty without a genuine prior price. We did not configure variations or extra gallery views.

Important field behaviour

Currency was read only in this actual form. Blank stock means unlimited; it is not zero. Save Draft first and inspect the saved row. Product activation and store design publication are separate checkpoints.

Make the storefront useful

Store design | Existing Everyday Retail template

Hero banner

Choose Full image background. Upload a suitable banner; set the headline and supporting text. Our headline: Build a clearer workspace. Button: Browse demo products.

Read the rendered result

Use background dimming and inspect text contrast. Our final preset uses a navy structure, teal artwork and orange buttons. A colour input is not proof that every template element changed.

Questions that help visitors

Add FAQ under Page sections. We answered: Can I place a real order? What does each sample price cover? Are these product photographs? Use complete, truthful answers.

Footer and saved draft

Add a clear explanation of the example. Save the design draft, check its status, then distinguish it from Publish. Review both desktop and the builder Mobile preview.

Your hero / button destination

Write one clear next action and the actual page it opens:

Publish carefully, then tour every page

Publication prerequisites depend on the live account

What happened in this demonstration

With every payment method off, Publish was blocked and the design draft retained. A temporary cash-only method allowed us to capture the labelled training pages. No online provider was connected and no order placed. Afterwards all methods were off and products Draft again.

A real launch needs a separate decision

Choose supported payment and fulfilment methods for your actual business. Test the appropriate payment environment and order workflow before accepting customers. Do not copy temporary demo settings into a live business.

Complete preview checklist

Home: announcement, hero, categories, products, information, FAQ, footer.

Shop: catalogue, category and sorting controls.

Category: correct filtered products.

Notebook, holder and clips: each complete product page.

On phone: readable text, image crops, navigation, quantity and cart.

How the lesson tour was made

The complete tour animates actual full-page browser captures from top to bottom. It is labelled on screen. Short pages are shown fully, not stretched. It is not a claim of continuous live scrolling.

Check the buying journey

Record actual results, including what you did not test

Product and basket

Open the notebook. Quantity2 at GHS120 should display GHS240. Reduce to1 and confirm GHS120. Remove the last item and check the empty basket.

Checkout boundary

We opened the initial checkout form only. We entered no customer details and did not press Place order. A checkout page is not proof of a successful purchase.

Before your real launch

Test supported payments, actual order creation, confirmation messages, stock changes and fulfilment in the correct environment. Use approved test data. Record any outstanding checks.

Your evidence log

Test / expected result / actual result / date / remaining action:

Practise and bring one useful question

Build one part, check it, then continue

Your next exercise

Create one accurate product and inspect it in visitor view. Repeat consistently for the next two. Keep a saved draft and do not accept real orders until your launch checks pass.

Useful links

Digi Assist AI: https://digiassistai.com

Tools: https://stevetoti.com/tools

Free worldwide community: https://www.buildprofitai.com/community

Video libraries: https://stevetoti.com/videos

https://www.buildprofitai.com/videos

Disclosure

Some links in the tools directory may earn Steve a commission at no extra cost to you. Free community membership does not mean every tool or course is free. This workbook accompanies a real software demonstration, not a promise of income or sales.

Ask the community

Which step was hardest: catalogue, storefront design or checking the basket? Record the exact screen and question, without passwords or private customer data.